João Lucas Almeida Pereira

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Unity Developer and Gameplay Programmer with 4+ years of experience building, optimizing and shipping games on mobile, desktop and console. Specialized in gameplay systems, performance work and bringing titles to hardware with tight constraints. Shipped 5 commercial titles on Nintendo Switch (input, UI, save systems, localization and platform compliance). Master's in Software Engineering focused on LLMs in serious games. Comfortable with C#, C++, Unity, Unreal Engine 5 and GameMaker, working closely with designers, artists and QA.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Game Nacional — Mid Game Developer

Apr 2024 – Present

- Ported and optimized 5 commercial titles for Nintendo Switch (Sunshine Farm, Tiny Little Farm, Felinea Tales, Pizza Maker, CatTerror), adapting input, UI and save systems to console constraints and platform compliance requirements.
- Profiled and fixed performance and stability issues on real hardware (stutter, crashes, memory) using Unity Profiler, frame debugger, object pooling and occlusion culling.
- Built gameplay features, UI flows and scene/prefab architecture in C#; also worked with GameMaker on console ports.
- Handled localization pipelines (including Japanese support), Unity String Tables and text layout fixes.
- Debugged scripts, prefabs, animations and physics using structured Git-based workflows.

GameForm — Game Developer / Game Designer / Concept Artist

Jul 2022 – Oct 2022

- Designed core gameplay systems, progression loops and reward structures for the mobile prototype of Data2073, including the card-based battle system and character mechanics.
- Created 120+ concept art assets and collaborated with the team to keep design and technical implementation aligned.

Agência Combogó — Game Developer Jr

Mar 2022 – Jul 2022

- Developed a prototype of the mobile puzzle-platformer O Resgate de Farya for iOS and Android, in partnership with the animation studio ViuCine.

RELEVANT PROJECTS

Sunshine Farm — Nintendo Switch port

nintendo.com/.../sunshine-farm-switch

- 2D farm game ported to Nintendo Switch (GameMaker) and published on the eShop. Worked on performance optimization, save system compatibility (async writes timed behind screen fades) and UI navigation for console controls. Fixed Japanese text overflow and font loading; added Japanese to the localization pipeline.

CatTerror: The Abandoned House — Jan–Mar 2025

nintendo.com/.../catterror-the-abandoned-house-switch

- 3D first-person horror title for Nintendo Switch. Optimized for the platform (lower texture resolution, object pooling, occlusion culling, view distance tuning). Adapted gameplay for Joy-Con and touchscreen in minigames and item inspection. Fixed stutter and crashes caused by monster instantiation by preloading the monster inactive and activating it on trigger.

Pizza Maker — Nov–Dec 2024

nintendo.com/.../pizza-maker-switch

- 2D kitchen simulator with deliveries for Nintendo Switch. Replaced mouse control with a virtual cursor driven by Joy-Con and adapted the save system for console requirements.

Felinea Tales — Oct–Nov 2024

nintendo.com/.../felinea-tales-switch

- 3D platformer for Nintendo Switch. Built the complete save system for Switch compatibility and improved localization by migrating from external file reading to Unity String Tables.

Tiny Little Farm — May–Jun 2024

nintendo.com/.../tiny-little-farm-switch

- 2D farm simulator for Nintendo Switch. Adapted the localization system to support Japanese.

ADHD Racers — Mar–Sep 2025 (Master’s thesis project)

- MVP of a 2D mobile racing game built for the master’s thesis on LLMs in serious games. Full gameplay loop (top-down racing + minigames), REST integration via UnityWebRequest, JSON serialization and LLM communication for adaptive responses. Core loop validated with mental health professionals.

Data2073 — Jul–Oct 2022

store.epicgames.com/p/data2073

• 3D Web3-focused card game. Prototyped the battle system with ScriptableObjects, character positioning and ability targeting. Created 120+ concept art assets.

O Resgate de Farya — Mar–Jul 2022
oresgatedefarya.itch.io

• 2D mobile puzzle-platformer in partnership with ViuCine. Built prototype with two playable characters, AI-controlled companion, mobile UI and core movement systems.

Only Wheels (2020) & Pugs and Plants (2019)

• University 3D racing prototype with physics-based vehicle control, power-ups, cel-shading pipeline and custom water shader (Shader Graph). Solo hyper-casual top-down shooter with wave systems, scoring, ranking and full art/UI made by me.

TECHNICAL KNOWLEDGE

Programming: C#, C++, SQL, OOP, SOLID
Game Development: Gameplay Systems, Game Architecture, UI Systems, Input Systems, AI, Physics, Animation, Localization, Performance Optimization
Engines: Unity, Unreal Engine 5, GameMaker Studio
Graphics & VFX: Shader Graph, VFX Graph, Particle Systems, Rendering & Performance Optimization
Platforms: PC, Mobile (iOS/Android), Nintendo Switch, Console Porting
Tools: Git, Visual Studio, VS Code, JIRA, Trello, Miro

EDUCATION

Master's in Software Engineering — CESAR School | 2023 – 2025
Postgraduate Specialization in Game Development — Universidade Estácio de Sá | 2023 – 2024
Bachelor's Degree in Game Development — Universidade Católica de Pernambuco | 2019 – 2022

LANGUAGES

Portuguese: Native · English: Upper-Intermediate B2 (Cambridge CAE) · French: Basic A1